

YouTube Transcript System

Two-page visual guide for collecting YouTube URLs, cleaning them, and generating transcript files.

Clean output preview

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Video 1
Date: 2024-06-18
Title: How to Build Better Offers

URL: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=abc123>
Duration: 18:42
Views: 124,532
Likes: 4,821

Full transcript in one paragraph...

What this creates

One clean transcript text file per creator. Each video includes number, date, title, URL, duration, views, likes if available, and the transcript in one paragraph.

Main rule

Keep everything inside the main Transcript System folder. CSVs go in input. Finished transcripts appear in output.



YouTube



Sheets



ChatGPT



WhisperFlow



YT-DLP



Terminal

Correct workflow order

1 Copy video blocks

Scroll to older videos, then copy the messy video blocks upward.

2 Clean hidden URLs

Paste into Sheets and run the Apps Script cleaner.

3 Save URL list

Export the cleaned sheet as a CSV. Header must be URL.

4 Install YT-DLP

Put the yt-dlp_macos folder inside tools and unblock it.

5 Create code with AI

Use ChatGPT floating window to generate and save the Python file.

6 Run transcript

Run one Terminal command and read the output txt file.

URL cleanup checklist

- ☐ Copy messy older YouTube video blocks.
- ☐ Paste into Google Sheets column A.
- ☐ Run Tools → Clean YouTube URLs.
- ☐ Download the cleaned sheet as a CSV.

CSV checklist

- ☐ File name = creator name.
- ☐ Column A header = URL.
- ☐ Put CSV files in input.
- ☐ One creator per CSV.

Build the System Once, Then Run It Anytime

After this setup, you only drop new CSV files into input and run one command.

Folder structure

```
Transcript System/  
  input/  
    Creator Name.csv  
  output/  
    Creator Name_transcript.txt  
  tools/  
    transcribe_youtube_csvs.py  
    yt-dlp_macos/  
      yt-dlp_macos  
      _internal/
```

Create the Python file

Run this from the main Transcript System folder. It creates the file and opens it in TextEdit.

```
touch tools/transcribe_youtube_csvs.py  
open -e tools/transcribe_youtube_csvs.py
```

Paste the code ChatGPT gives you, then press Command + S.

Short ChatGPT prompt to generate the Python code

Create a Python script for a macOS YouTube transcript system. Folder structure: Transcript System with input, output and tools. Read every CSV in input where column A header is URL. Skip CSVs already transcribed in output. Use tools/yt-dlp_macos/yt-dlp_macos to pull YouTube metadata and English auto captions. Save one txt file per CSV as Creator_transcript.txt. At the top put the channel name. For each video include Video number, Date, Title, URL, Duration, Views, Likes if available, then three blank lines, then the full transcript in one paragraph. Keep the code simple.

Run the system

```
chmod 755 tools/yt-dlp_macos/yt-dlp_macos  
xattr -cr tools/yt-dlp_macos  
python3 tools/transcribe_youtube_csvs.py
```

Run checklist

- ☐ Terminal is opened in the main folder.
- ☐ CSV files are inside input.
- ☐ yt-dlp executable path is correct.
- ☐ Output file appears in output.

If it fails

Permission denied usually means Mac blocked yt-dlp or the script points to the wrong file. The real executable should be:
tools/yt-dlp_macos/yt-dlp_macos

If a transcript already exists, delete that txt file to regenerate it.